



STONE RAGE

A PROTESTOR HOLDS stones as he prepares to throw them at policemen trying to control a demonstration in Shopian, Jammu & Kashmir. It was brickbats for security personnel as the state erupted for two weeks in protest following the alleged rape and murder of two women by the armed forces.

AHMEDABAD | Mob Justice

The arrest of three Muslim boys for the alleged rape of a schoolgirl has opened a can of worms in Surat. A police investigation reveals that the trio was involved in seven other gangrapes, which they recorded to blackmail their victims. Two of the accused are sons of Gujarat police officers while one's father owns a mobile phone shop. The three posed as policemen to get the girl into the car they were in. The state Government was swift to act. Home Minister Amit Shah transferred Surat's Police Commissioner Dipak Swaroop and announced that the case—and future rape cases—will be tried in a fast-track court. The bandh call given by the Vishwa Hindu Parishad did not have the desired impact, though public mood in the city has been simmering. An angry mob resorted to thrashing the accused while they were being medically examined in a hospital after their arrest.

by Uday Mahurkar

THE THREE ACCUSED, AND FUTURE RAPE CASES, WILL BE TRIED IN A FAST-TRACK COURT.



A MASKED VIGILANTE HITS ONE OF THE ACCUSED